

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7 4 3

♥ 6

♦ Q 10 9 2

♣ Q 8 7 3

♠ A K

♥ K 10 3

♦ A K 8 6

♣ A J 10 9



♠ 10 9 8 5 2

♥ 9 7 5 2

♦ J 4

♣ K 5

♠ Q 6

♥ A Q J 8 4

♦ 7 5 3

♣ 6 4 2

West

North

East

South

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

Lead: ♠ 10

North is to play 6NT. East leads the ♠ 10, dummy plays the ♠ 6 and West the ♠ 3.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=5 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 10

You need two more winners and the best bet is to try to pick up three ♣ tricks. You will need the ♣K and ♣Q to lie in different hands, or both of them to be with West. That is about a 75% chance.

But you may need to make 3 finesses, so that means 3 entries to dummy, all of which must be in the ♥ suit. Can it be done?

You win the ♠ lead in your hand, then lead the ♥K and East plays low.

West follows with the ♥6.

West plays low.

Of course it can. Win the ♠ lead in your hand and play the ♥K, overtaking with dummy's ♥A. Now play a ♣ to your ♣9, which loses to East's ♣K. East plays another ♠.

Now play the ♥10, and when East follows you are safe to overtake with dummy's ♥J since you can tell that West did not start with 4 ♥s. In fact, West shows out so it is East who started with 4 ♥s but that won't be a problem for you. Play another ♣ from dummy, finessing the ♣10 which wins.

Now play your ♥3 toward dummy, finessing the ♥8 when East follows with a low card. Play dummy's two ♥ winners, discarding ♦s, then the low ♣ to your ♣J. Wow.

The making of a Plan is a very important step in being a good Declarer.

And as you have figured by now, assessing how many entries you are going to need is big part of that plan. Like here, if you had won a single ♥ trick in your hand then you wouldn't have had the three entries to dummy.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8
 ♥ A K 8 6 5 4 3
 ♦ 8 5 4
 ♣ Q 3

♠ 6 5 3 2
 ♥ Q 10 7
 ♦ 9 7
 ♣ K 9 7 4

	N	
W		E
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♠ A K Q J 9 7
 ♥ —
 ♦ A K 6 2
 ♣ A J 5

♠ 10 4
 ♥ J 9 2
 ♦ Q J 10 3
 ♣ 10 8 6 2

West	North	East	South
		2♣	Pass
2♥	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♥	Pass	6♠	
All Pass			
6♠ by East			
Lead: ♦Q			

then you have a dummy entry in the form of the ♣Q. If they refuse to take the trick you will counter by next laying down the ♣A, then ruffing a third ♣ to get to dummy and the two golden eggs.

The first time I ever saw this type of play in a book I fell in love with it.

My dream is that someday I will get a chance to use it at the table. If you ever do be sure and email me.

Pretty bold bidding by East, but partner DID make a positive response. East is to play 6♠. South leads the ♦Q, dummy plays the ♦4 and North the ♦7.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 3

OK, the plan is to get over to dummy for those two ♥ winners.

If you just play a small ♣ toward the ♣Q that will work whenever South holds the ♣K.

How about playing ♣A an a small ♣, planning on ruffing your third ♣ to get to dummy? Naaah. They will win the second ♣ and play a trump.

There is actually a play that is 100% certain, no matter who holds the ♣K.

Win the opening lead and lay down your ♣J. The defense is helpless. If they take the ♣J with the ♣K,